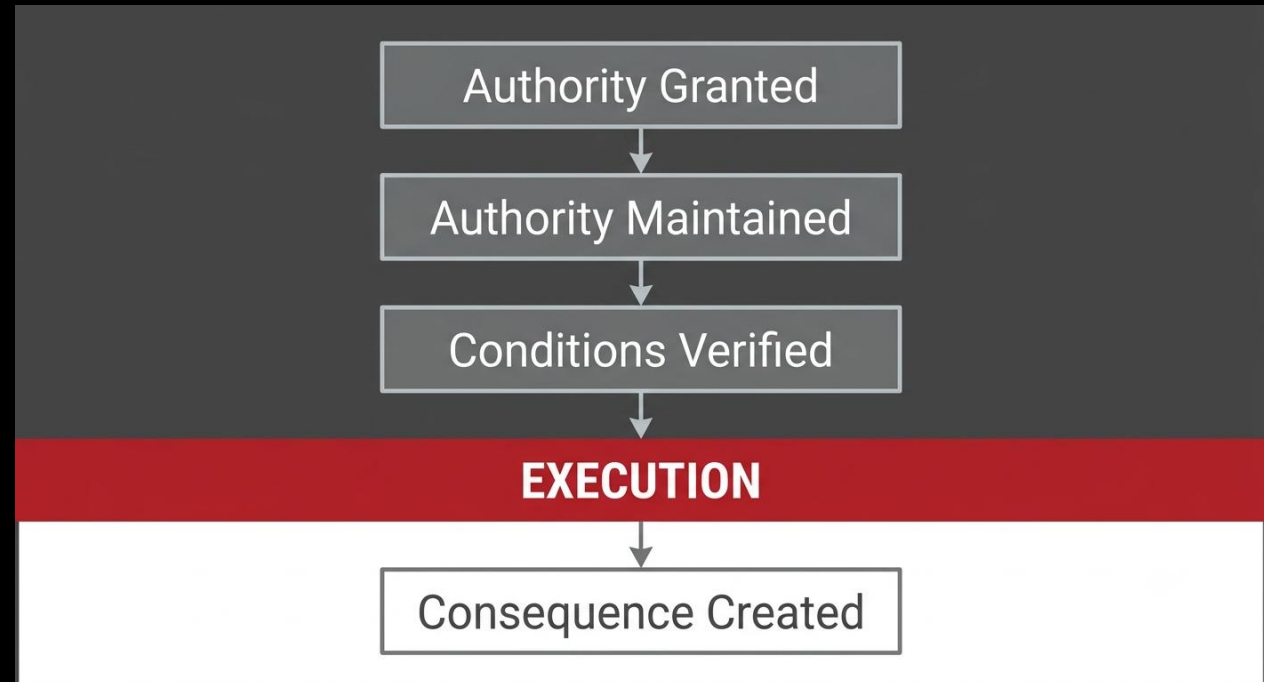


EXECUTION IS THE MOMENT GOVERNANCE BECOMES CONSEQUENCE

Enterprise governance determines
what should happen. Execution
determines what actually happens.

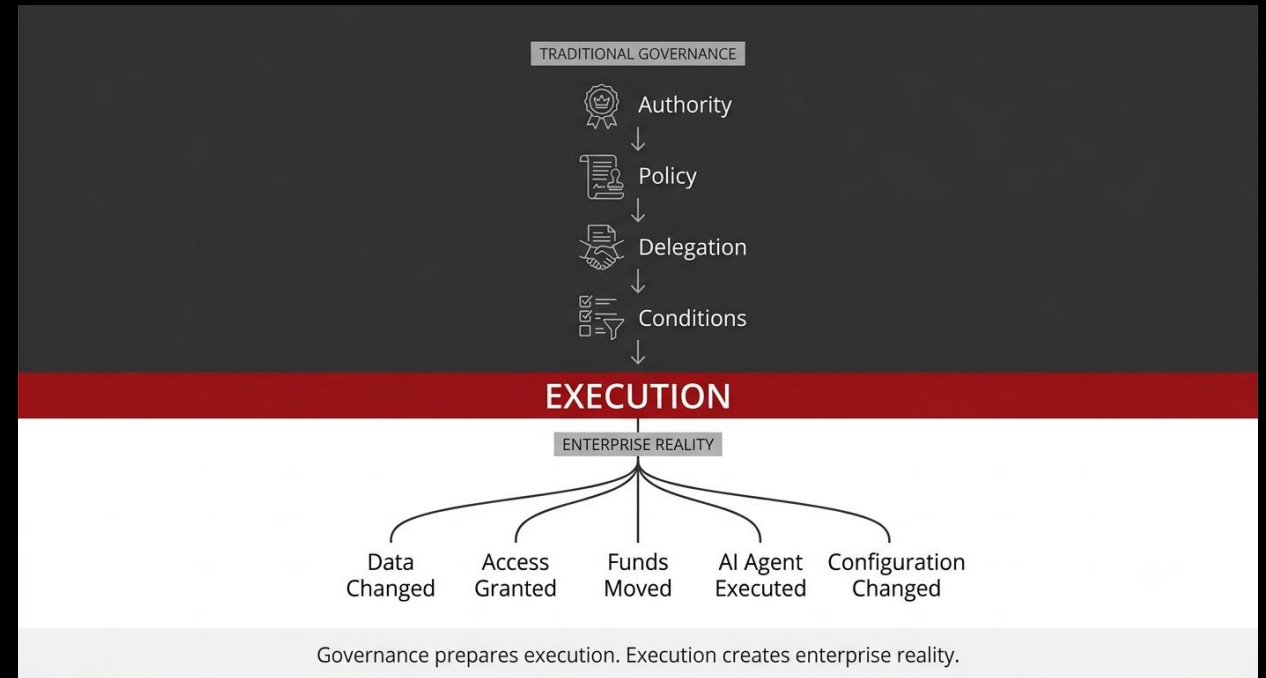
Authority creates possibility.
Execution creates consequence.



GOVERNANCE PREPARES EXECUTION

- Authority
- Policy
- Delegation
- Conditions

Execution transforms governance into enterprise reality.



EXECUTION CREATES A NEW GOVERNANCE QUESTION

Before execution: authority exists.

After execution: consequence exists.

Execution is the irreversible governance boundary.

BEFORE EXECUTION

Authority Policy
Delegation Conditions

Permission Established

EXECUTION

AFTER EXECUTION

Authority Still Valid? Intent Preserved?
Delegation Still Legitimate? Consequence Acceptable?

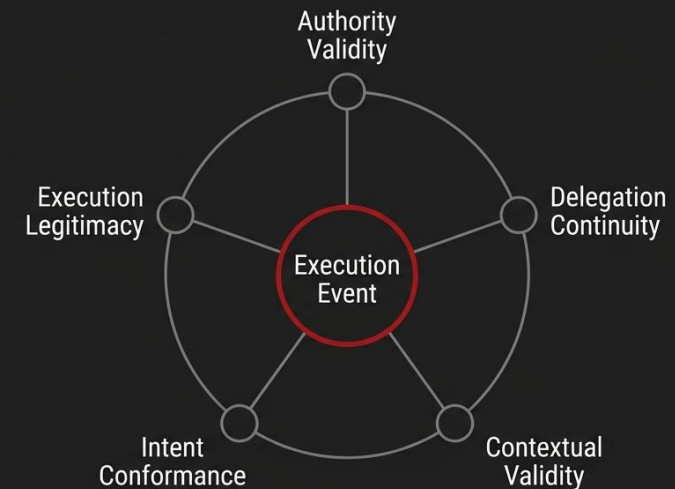
Legitimacy Unknown

Traditional governance determines whether execution may begin. Runtime Governance determines whether execution remained legitimate. ✦

RUNTIME GOVERNANCE EVALUATES EXECUTION

Traditional Governance:
Can this occur?

Runtime Governance
Was this execution a legitimate
exercise of authority



Runtime Governance evaluates execution as a composite governance event.

No single governance control can independently determine execution legitimacy.
Execution legitimacy emerges from the combined evaluation of authority, delegation, context, intent, and execution.

ACCOUNTABILITY REQUIRES EXECUTION VALIDATION

Distributed systems execute from many local authority states.
The enterprise experiences one consequence.

TRADITIONAL GOVERNANCE

- Was authority granted?
- Was policy satisfied?
- Was delegation approved?
- Were conditions met?

Decision to Execute

Governance
Focus Shifts



RUNTIME GOVERNANCE

- Did authority remain valid?
- Did delegation remain continuous?
- Did context remain valid?
- Was execution legitimate?

Execution Validated

Execution changes the governance question.

Traditional governance authorizes execution. Runtime Governance validates execution **legitimacy**.

Accountability requires proving that authority remained legitimate when that consequence was created.

Traditional governance authorizes execution. Runtime Governance validates execution legitimacy

Related Frameworks

FW-001 Runtime Governance

FW-004 Execution Legitimacy

RRB-046

FIG-001 through FIG-005

GOVERNANCE LAW 046

AUTHORITY CREATES POSSIBILITY.

EXECUTION CREATES CONSEQUENCE.

Runtime Governance determines whether that consequence was created through legitimate authority.



AOIntegrity.ai
Architecture of Integrity

Residual Risk Brief
RRB-046 | Execution and Consequence | Version 2.0
AO Integrity Research | 2026



AO Integrity.

ARCHITECTURE OF INTEGRITY